Justin Mills

When I was 18 years old I made a mistake in my life that got me sent to an Idaho state prison [illegible] program. This was at an age when others at my age were being introduced to college. But I was introduced to prison politics and the way of life in prison. I had very little options for educational programs. I was locked away with people facing alot of time. we were not givin much to challenge our minds so we mostly just gamoled all day and paid to listne to music. the prison gang mentality was very strong where I was sent. Being in a prison gang makes you feel like your time will be easier out there [illegible] negetive things that come with it. Since I was the youngest in the pod I was constantly targeted by older gang members. the most dominent person will try to pull you in and influence you. I Belive I should have been givin more tools and programs that help me pull my mind away from the negetivity, and help me better myself and prepare for my future after completing my prison programe. I was only out for one day before I made a probation violation that got me sent to County jail. here I am once agin locked in a Room full of older males were some are facing up to 20 years. I will be locked in this Room while the court process plays out. we are not aloud to have Books in here. we do not see sunlight. we have no programs

r educational Resources. Every day is the same we
just play cards and watch tv all day. I am very
yper active and that can make doing time difficult.
But I Belive it can be used as a tool to help me learn
and work harder I know I am intelligent I just
made a few mistakes I know I can have a Bright
uture. But in this System I am not givin the opportunitys
r resources to do my best. In prison we have personal
ablets and in this County jail we have tablets.
I can see potential for powerfur tools to be developed
to help people like me be more productive in these
ypes of environments. Education needs to be free and
ccesible. If the government takes Responsibility to
ock people away then they should also be Responsible
o provide education and Resources to better themselves.
l judge does not know what it's like to live in this
nvironment or what it does to your mind. no
ne does unless they lived it. I think providing free
ducation to inmates is a good start to change
the world!

Justin Mills 20
2 years